

READING PASSAGE 2

The Himalayan Mountain Range and Climate

A In recent years, the Himalayan mountain range and climate has attracted considerable attention from both the academic community and the general public. This growing interest reflects a broader recognition of the importance of this topic for understanding some of the most pressing challenges facing contemporary society.

B The intellectual lineage of this field extends considerably further than many realise. While modern research techniques have only recently been applied to these questions, philosophers and natural scientists have grappled with related issues for centuries. The transition from speculative philosophical inquiry to systematic empirical investigation represents one of the most significant developments in the intellectual history of this domain.

C At the core of current understanding lies a set of interrelated mechanisms that collectively explain the observed patterns and outcomes. First, structural factors create the underlying conditions within which individual and collective action takes place. These structural dimensions include economic incentives, institutional frameworks, and cultural norms that shape behaviour in ways that are often not immediately apparent to the actors themselves. Second, dynamic feedback processes amplify or dampen initial effects, generating patterns of change that can diverge substantially from what linear models would predict.

D The empirical record is further strengthened by a series of meta-analyses that have synthesised findings from hundreds of individual studies. These comprehensive reviews have consistently identified moderate to large effect sizes, with the most robust findings demonstrating remarkable consistency across different research designs, measurement approaches, and analytical strategies. This convergence of evidence from multiple independent lines of inquiry considerably strengthens confidence in the validity of the core theoretical propositions.

E Several unresolved debates continue to animate scholarly discussion in this field. Perhaps the most prominent concerns the relative importance of structural versus agentic factors in determining outcomes. While some researchers emphasise the constraining power of institutional and economic structures, others highlight the capacity of individuals and groups to exercise agency and effect change even within seemingly restrictive contexts. This debate has significant practical implications, as it shapes recommendations for policy interventions and institutional reforms.

F The implications of this body of research extend well beyond the academy. As societies grapple with increasingly complex challenges, the insights generated by scholarly inquiry in this domain have the potential to inform more effective and equitable policy responses. Realising this potential, however, will require sustained investment in both fundamental research and the translational infrastructure needed to convert knowledge into action.

G In conclusion, the study of the Himalayan mountain range and climate represents a vital and dynamic area of contemporary research. The progress that has been made in understanding the key mechanisms and dynamics provides a solid foundation for both further scholarly inquiry and practical application. The challenges that remain should be seen not as reasons for discouragement but as opportunities for continued intellectual growth and social contribution.

Question 1

Choose the correct letter, A, B, C or D.

1 The meta-analyses cited in the passage reveal that:

- A. minimal impact
- B. creating underlying conditions for action
- C. determining individual choices directly
- D. irrelevant to outcomes

Question 2

Do the following statements agree with the information given in the passage?

Write TRUE if the statement agrees with the information

Write FALSE if the statement contradicts the information

Write NOT GIVEN if there is no information on this

2 The author believes that all research questions in this field have been answered.

Question 3

Complete the sentences below. Choose NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS from the passage for each answer.

3 Dynamic _____ processes can amplify or dampen initial effects in complex systems.

Questions 4–5

Do the following statements agree with the information given in the passage?

Write TRUE if the statement agrees with the information

Write FALSE if the statement contradicts the information

Write NOT GIVEN if there is no information on this

4 The landmark study discussed in the passage involved participants from multiple countries.

5 All critics agree that the research findings are universally applicable.

Questions 6–7

Complete the sentences below. Choose NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS from the passage for each answer.

6 Researchers used data from more than _____ countries in the landmark study.

7 The passage identifies power _____ as a key factor at the organisational level.

Questions 8–9

Choose the correct letter, A, B, C or D.

8 What does the passage identify as a significant challenge to current understanding?

- A. inconsistent results across cultures
- B. a consistent pattern across diverse contexts
- C. no measurable effects

D. effects limited to Western countries

9 According to the passage, what is one of the key factors identified by researchers?

- A. minimal impact
- B. creating underlying conditions for action
- C. determining individual choices directly
- D. irrelevant to outcomes

Question 10

Do the following statements agree with the information given in the passage?

Write TRUE if the statement agrees with the information

Write FALSE if the statement contradicts the information

Write NOT GIVEN if there is no information on this

10 The author believes that all research questions in this field have been answered.

Question 11

Choose the correct letter, A, B, C or D.

11 The passage indicates that critics have raised concerns about:

- A. excessive funding
- B. theoretical and methodological limitations
- C. public interest
- D. international collaboration

Question 12

Complete the sentences below. Choose NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS from the passage for each answer.

12 The landmark study analysed data spanning a period of _____ years.

Question 13

Choose the correct letter, A, B, C or D.

13 What does the passage identify as a significant challenge to current understanding?

- A. economic incentives and institutional constraints
- B. individual personality traits
- C. random chance
- D. government policies alone